

MCP coverage of HTNS, Housing Deposits, HTSS, Short-Term Post-Hospitalization Housing, Recuperative Care, and Day Habilitation **is strongly encouraged but remains optional**. MCPs have had the option to cover these services since January 1, 2022.

Transitional Rent will become a **mandatory** service beginning January 1, 2026, and will be implemented in phases for select eligible populations (see Section VII on Transitional Rent). MCPs may also opt to cover Transitional Rent as early as July 1, 2025.

When MCPs launch coverage of Transitional Rent, their continued coverage of other Community Supports for Members experiencing or at risk of homelessness—particularly HTNS, Housing Deposits, and HTSS (collectively referred to as the Housing Trio)—is critical to helping Members identify, secure, and sustain permanent housing.

B. Housing Support Plan

A Member's housing support plan sets forth a plan for achieving the individual's housing goals that is based on the individual's needs, preferences, and barriers to housing. It is a key tool that acts as a personalized roadmap to help a Member on their journey from homelessness or housing instability into long-term housing stability. A housing support plan can help ensure that time-limited Room and Board services¹⁸ will be provided in ways that best contribute to the long-term housing stability of the Member. The development and maintenance of a housing support plan has always been part of the expectation for the Housing Trio; with the addition of Transitional Rent, DHCS is emphasizing the key role that it plays across the services.

When a Housing Support Plan is Required

DHCS requires MCPs to ensure that a Member has a housing support plan in place as a condition for authorizing a Member for Transitional Rent, whether the Member is placed in an interim or permanent setting (see Section VII.F for detail on Transitional Rent authorization). In many or most cases, the Member being referred for Transitional Rent/Housing Deposits has received or is receiving HTNS, and thus has a housing support plan that has been developed by the Member's HTNS Provider in conjunction with the Member.¹⁹ However, DHCS recognizes that similar housing navigation may be provided outside Community Supports. In addition, a Member is not specifically required to have received HTNS as a condition of being able to receive Transitional Rent

¹⁸ See details on the six-month global cap on Room and Board services in Section IV.

¹⁹ Development of a housing support plan is one of the HTNS activities in the HTNS service description (see Section VI.1).